Defy the Crown (and Heartbreak)

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Explicit

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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by ResFlower

Summary

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"So ... that's it then?" Catra shakes her head, lips pursed. "We're married and then tomorrow we aren't?"

Adora clenches her hands, her stomach rolling with nausea at the thought. "If that's what you want." She tries to meet Catra's eyes, but it’s too hard. "You don't have to be here against your will."

Perhaps she’s being unfair. Adora didn’t have to move to a new land full of strangers. She got to keep her life exactly as it was save for their union. If Catra wishes for her life in Halfmoon—the life she’s always known—Adora will have to find it in herself not to blame her for it.

It doesn’t make it an easy task. Adora almost feels like she's not in her own body—like she's floating above them in the moment, watching as this precious, tender thing she thought she had collapses before her.

She flinches when she feels Catra's hand on her own, not expecting it. She raises her gaze from the lush carpet to find Catra's eyes full of tears. "What if I don't want that? What if I wanted to stay?"

OR Sequel to Accede the Throne.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Adora's never felt more defeated in all her life. She's not accustomed to it—she's the crown princess, and typically she gets her way, as spoiled as it might be to admit. It's especially the case when it's something important, but that isn't what happened today.

She walked around in a fog for most of the afternoon after her parents provided her with the most unsettling news—that her in-laws had come to take Catra back to Halfmoon. That their marriage, no longer needed because of the unceremonious end to the war with the Horde, would be found null and void by both Eternia and Halfmoon.

Adora can hardly understand it. She and Catra have been married for months now—how can everyone expect her to pretend it never happened? She knows it was not a love match to start, but that's changed for Adora almost as quickly as she pledged herself to the woman.

Catra is like no one she's ever known. It's not only her enchanting beauty and her quick wit—the things that first drew Adora in and ensnared her. Catra is also unfailingly kind, loyal, and a keen strategist. But more than that, Adora can't point to a single attribute that makes her the woman Adora loves.

She just knows that when she sits down beside her at a meeting or lays down beside her as they prepare to rest for the day, she's never been happier or more at peace. Adora lives for their conversations, for the quiet moments when they get to be Adora and Catra together, not the princesses who will one day rule Eternia.

Apparently, all of that has turned to ash in a moment's notice.

Her first instinct had been to demand that her parents tell the regents of Halfmoon in no uncertain terms that Catra would not be returning. That she belonged with Adora here in Eternia. But then Adora realized that Catra wouldn't be returning if she didn't

want to. Adora knows Catra corresponds frequently with her mother—it would be an odd thing, for her not to know this was coming.

So, Adora stayed silent. Because as much as she doesn't wish for her marriage to disintegrate before her very eyes, she cannot keep it alive alone.

Her shoulders slump the moment she's in the privacy of her own room. She tugs off her shoes without thinking too much about the motions of it. Adora bites her lip, trying to keep from sobbing—her chest feels too tight as does her throat, but she doesn't know if Catra will return, and she hardly wants to be found crying like a child if she does.

As if called by Adora's very thoughts, she hears the door to their bedroom open. "Adora?" She sucks in a sharp breath at the sound of Catra's tentative call, squeezing her eyes shut. She doesn't turn around, even as she hears Catra padding closer. "Are you alright?"

"It's been a trying day." It's the most delicate way she can think to put it.

"Why?"

Adora's jaw is set, her eyes looking up as if she can see straight through the ceiling and up to the sky. She wishes she could see all the way to some deity who she could fight to mend this.

She can't bear to lay her eyes on Catra. Not now that she may very well lose her. Instead, she turns around and riffles through her clothes, looking for something to wear for the night. They usually take to bed naked, but it feels like too much right now.

There's no avoiding this discussion—as early as tomorrow they could be signing their annulment. It feels more like a death warrant. Adora turns around and looks at Catra. She's holding herself, eyeing Adora in a cautious way that makes her think her wife is feigning ignorance.

"I expect you very much know. Did your parents fail to speak to you about the annulment?" She takes a step forward before thinking better of it and turning back to her closet. “Or did it slip your mind?” She can feel some anger leaking into her voice, try as she might to avoid it.

"I—they did broach that topic." Adora knows what her wife sounds like when she's nervous. She just doesn't know *why* Catra is nervous—perhaps she's worried about how she's going to cleave Adora's heart in two. She’s never taken Catra to be purposefully unkind, especially to her.

Adora stops picking through her clothes, her hands tight around bunched up fabric. "Do you wish to go back to Halfmoon?" She asks the only question that matters—the one that’s been looping in her head all day making her dizzy. She thought they were happy, at least to a degree. Adora always thought herself to be more emotionally involved in their marriage than Catra, but she never imagined her upset to the point of wishing it gone.

"Do you wish me to leave?" Catra returns evenly.

Frustration builds in Adora's chest. She turns, glancing somewhere over Catra. "I asked first."

Catra scoffs, crossing her arms over her chest. "I asked second."

"You—why has Halfmoon requested this with such vigor? Why have your parents come all this way to demand that you be returned to them?" Adora bites her lip, trying to hold her tears at bay. "The only reason I can think of is that you asked them to. That you're unhappy with this—with our arrangement."

Adora can’t bring herself to say the word marriage. She takes a deep breath through her nose, finally looking at Catra head on. Her hair is a bit of a mess, her mouth held open in surprise. She looks no less beautiful than when Adora kissed her good morning, before reality came crashing down on her today.

She crosses her arms over her chest, a look akin to betrayal marring her face. "You really think that?"

"I don't know what to think."

Adora knows it's only been two months of marriage, but she doesn't need more time to know she's in love with Catra. In truth, she'd handed some part of herself over to Catra the moment they married, even as strangers.

She curses herself for not declaring her love—for not doing more to make Catra fall in love with her. She didn't want to startle Catra. She'd thought of their marriage as something she could carefully tend to, and with time she might be rewarded—might be loved in return. But it seems Adora has no time left.

"I didn't ask them to come for me." Catra looks tired and Adora would give all she has to wrap her arms around her and provide comfort. She holds back, not sure that it would be well received. "I'm just as surprised as you are by this."

Adora blinks. "It's really just because the Horde isn't the threat we thought it was?"

She nods her head slowly. "My parents want me to rule Halfmoon. They never wanted me to abdicate." She shrugs. "They saw the marriage as a matter of survival."

"You never answered my question." She points out with some regret, turning back the conversation to what's most important. "Whether you align with your parents on this."

"You never answered mine either."

She shakes her head. "Of course I don't want you to go." Adora breathes out. "What could possibly make you suspect that I'd want anything but for you to stay?"

She feels that she’s been blatant in her affection for Catra, even if she hasn’t said the words aloud. Adora makes sure to come to

bed every night when Catra does holding her through the night, she leaves Catra flowers in her study, she seeks her out at every possible turn.

Catra watches her with some trepidation. "Your parents accepted without protest. It's highly unusual to allow an annulment after, clearly ... well, we've been married for some time." Her cheeks blush and Adora is momentarily distracted by the rush of color. "I could only think of one reason for that."

"You thought I asked them to accept?"

Catra shrugs. "What else was I to think?"

"That's—gods, I hate this." She groans, putting her hands to her temple. "They don't want to upset relations with your Kingdom and see no harm in the annulment."

She'd wanted to argue with her father, to oppose the annulment until she was blue in the face, but she couldn't. Not without knowing if this is what Catra wants.

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Her knees almost buckle at the soft request. "Then please, don't go." Adora clutches Catra's hand tightly. "We can talk to our parents and resolve it. Don't leave me."

Catra closes the small distance remaining pressing her face into Adora's shoulder. She quickly wraps her arms around Catra, holding her tight as if that'll keep her here.

"I don't want to leave." Catra sobs out, her voice shaking. "I—Adora, I love you."

Adora shakes with wonder and relief—it comes out as tears as she places soft kisses in Catra's hair. "I love you too." She manages to say after a few breaths. "If you want to stay married, I don't care what we have to do to make it so. Whatever it takes."

Catra lets out a short watery laugh. "I very much want to stay married."

"Good." Adora puts her hands to Catra's cheeks, wiping away her tears. "Because I don't know what I'd do without my wife."

"Flatterer." Catra's smiling as she levies the accusation, and that's all that matters.

Adora leans down and kisses Catra and it tastes like relief and love. Catra immediately deepens the kiss, her arms looping around Adora's neck and pulling her down.

Adora lets her lead the way until they're practically panting into each other's mouths. Adora pulls back a little and Catra lets out a soft whine.

"Darling, please." Adora chuckles, amused by how Catra is put off by even an inch of distance. "Let me take off my jacket."

Catra looks down at Adora's formal wear and raises an eyebrow. "You should take it all off."

"Is that what you want?" Adora places another kiss on Catra's lips, this one almost chaste.

Catra looks at her steadily. "Yes. I want to lay in our bed naked together. And then I want you to touch me and assure me that everything will be alright."

She nods softly. "We're going to be much better than alright." Adora promises, quickly shrugging off her jacket.

Catra's hands find their way to Adora's shirt and pull hard, some of the buttons clattering onto the ground as she rips it open. Adora can't find it in herself to care, not when she can taste the desperation in Catra's kiss. She tugs on Catra's legs pulling until she's off the ground, her thighs hitched around Adora's hips.

Adora almost loses her balance when Catra tries to tug her shirt off. She moves forward, laying down on the bed. Catra is one-minded in her quest to get them both bare, refusing to move until she finally manages to pull off their shirts.

Adora crushes her into the bed, kissing her fiercely. She can hardly believe her luck—she’s spent all day preparing for the worst news only to learn that she's loved in return.

Catra's hand reaches for the waistband of her pants, shoving it down. Adora grabs her hand, pulling it up higher on her back. "Catra, give me a moment."

"Something wrong?"

"No—I just—" Adora burrows her head in Catra's neck, dropping a kiss there. "I feel a little overwhelmed." She admits.

It’s a welcome change, but the whiplash is striking. Adora feels warm all over, a buzzing excitement on her skin as she tries to grapple with her new reality.

Catra's hand softly cups her face. "Whatever you need." She rests against Adora the weight of her body, a comforting thing.

"I love you. I love you. I love you." She presses kisses to Catra's skin between each word. "I can't believe you love me." She marvels at the thought. Adora hoped that one day she'd do enough to earn Catra's love but never in her wildest imaginations did she think that she already had it.

"Believe it, princess." Catra places her own kisses on Adora's face and her temples.

Adora's eyes glance down—from this angle Catra's breasts are hanging in front of her, soft and pert. She places a kiss on her flesh, one of her hands reaches out to touch her though the fabric of her brassiere.

Catra's eyes close, her breathing more ragged as she presses forward into Adora's hand. She lets put a moan as Adora slips her hand inside, gently tweaking her nipples.

She pulls at the neckline with her other hand until it's stretched low, Catra's cleavage spilling out. She ducks and presses soft, open mouth kisses around the fleshy mound of her tit, listening for her stuttered breath.

"Can I—please, take this off?"

Catra nods, her hands reaching down and pulling on fabrics quickly. "You're the one who needed a moment." She points out, a slight laugh in her voice. "It seems short lived."

"It's not my fault my wife is the most beautiful woman in all the lands."

"I bet I'd look even more beautiful if you helped me out of these clothes."

Adora lets out a soft laugh at the mixture of frustration and fluster on Catra's face. She lowers her hand, gripping her underwear, and

tugging it down, letting Catra shimmy and move as needed until the fabric is off.

It's not a seductive disrobing but Adora might prefer it—it feels honest and real, which is all she wants for her marriage. She wants all of Catra and she no longer has to hold back.

Catra is stark naked now, still laying across Adora. She tugs on Adora's singlet. "And you?"

"I was more worried about you." Adora lets her gaze trail over Catra astride her hips, one confident eyebrow raised in question. "I want to touch you."

"And I want you naked too, wife." The teasing glint in her eyes accompanied by her tender smile makes Adora's heart feel like it's going to fly out of her chest.

"Well, I can hardly deny that." She doesn't want to deny Catra anything. Adora wants to revel in doting on her and giving her exactly what she asks for.

She busies herself by removing the last thing covering her breasts, her skin pricking as Catra moves to touch her, hands traveling over her torso and then over her nipples.

She doesn't let it distract her from Catra though—she grips her wife's hips, gently tugging her so that she's straddling Adora's thigh.

Her fingers lose their steadiness and her eyes flutter shut as she brings her hips down, finding pressure against Adora's leg. Her eyes open for a moment and she almost manages a glare.

"You're only half naked." She accuses, even as she rocks against Adora's clothed leg.

"I'll take off the rest of it after you fall apart." Adora can’t even think about moving Catra from where she is, she has no desire to.

Catra's breath hitches and she bites her lip. "You seem very confident in that."

Adora leans forward licking Catra's nipple and sucking on it. Catra releases a sharp cry, her hands wrapping around Adora to steady herself. She pulls back enough that she can watch Catra as she rides her thigh, and it pulls the air out of Adora's lungs. She's so gorgeous, her face contorted in a needy way that calls on Adora to give her more.

“I am, love.” Adora reaches one of her hands into Catra’s hair, pleased by the moan she hears when she lightly tugs at the roots. “Because I know you and I’ll give you exactly what you want.”

Catra shoots her a half-hearted glare before gripping her back and renewing her efforts, rocking harder than before. Adora can feel the fabric where Catra is rubbing against it and in turn, she feels her gut lurch. She lets her lips find purchase on Catra’s skin, rocking her own hips enough so that she can provide the friction Catra needs but not so much as to disturb her balance.

Adora idly wonders if she could have an orgasm solely from looking at her wife like this. She’s certain there’s not a single more sensual being alive. From the curve of her jaw, down her neck, to her soft torso and fine legs, every inch of Catra is a treasure—something for Adora to rediscover as if new.

Her keens become higher in pitch and more of her weight falls on Adora as her hips move with abandon. Adora slips her hand between their bodies, her fingers finding the place where she’s most wet and then circling her nub.

Catra’s eyes fly open at that, a soft gasp on her lips. “Yes, Adora—that.” She begs, her curls falling on her face as she leans forward.

Adora tries her best to keep her hand steady, to flex her legs and keep Catra astride her thigh. She could watch this forever, the way that Catra slowly loses her composure until she forgets herself—it might be her favorite thing in the world.

“What do you need, Catra?” Adora manages to hiss out as she moves her other hand to palm Catra’s tits, tweaking a nipple. “I love—”

Catra lets out a grunt, her body weight thrust open Adora as her legs tremble for a long moment. Adora doesn’t stop moving her hand, trying her best to gauge when Catra crosses the line into oversensitive. She feels Catra slowly relax, her head nestled in the crook of Adora’s neck as she lets out a soft sigh.

“I fear I’ve ruined your pants.” She murmurs against Adora’s collarbone.

Adora lets out a short laugh. “I could not care less about that.” She kisses Catra’s temple, her arms wrapping around her. “I love you.”

Catra nuzzles against her. “I love you too.” She leans over until she’s no longer on top of Adora, instead next to her on the bed. She pushes against Adora’s shoulder until she picks up the hint and lays down.

She wastes no time before unbuckling Adora’s belt and pulling down her pants and underwear all at once. Her cunt feels cool when exposed to the air and she can feel some of her wetness spread on her thighs.

Catra seems to be taking her in, perched between her legs. “I’m going to enjoy this.” Is all the warning Adora receives before Catra starts dropping languid kisses on the outside of her knee.

Adora feels her head spin at the sudden change of pace, but it feels good and familiar—Catra has assured her more than once that she enjoys Adora’s body the same way that Adora does hers. It’s something Adora has grown to love over time, even when she was more unsure at the start of their marriage.

There’s something so vulnerable about letting someone touch her and look at her in such an intimate way, and Adora has never been good at being vulnerable. But with Catra, she wants to be.

Catra slowly trails kisses up Adora's legs, occasionally switching between the two. She can feel herself twitching in anticipation. She suspects Catra knows this, and it makes her slow down, her teeth nibbling across the inside of Adora's thighs.

"Catra?" She doesn't mean for it to be a question, but she's not sure what else to say.

Catra looks up at her, and Adora bites back a moan at how she looks. She has a half smirk on her face but her eyes are both mischievous and tender, confirming she knows exactly what she's doing to Adora.

"Yes, princess?" It's so warm that Adora hardly minds that Catra seems to be withholding from her.

"Do you think you'll find it in yourself to fuck me this century?"

Catra lets out a sharp laugh of surprise. One of Catra's fingers slips through Adora's slick, causing her to cry out. "Maybe, if you're good." She teases before leaning up and placing a kiss on Adora's hip. When she pulls back her eyes are more serious. "Don't worry, wife. I'm going to take care of you."

There's something about the fond way Catra looks at her as she says it, about the soft bite she bestows upon her hip as if it's a punctuation of her statement that makes it feel brand new. Catra has promised a number of times to take care of her, but this time, Adora doesn't have to wish for it to mean more than just a promise rooted in desire. This time, Adora knows she's loved.

She nods her head smiling down at the beautiful woman that somehow belongs with her. The emotionally charged moment seems to be enough to inspire Catra to lean forward and lick her. The first few swipes of her tongue are tentative, but Adora moans out anyway. She can't help it.

Her eyes flutter shut the moment Catra starts working a finger into her. Adora doesn't need much else in terms of penetration but she's not worried—Catra knows. Her tongue is warm, and Adora

tries to fight the desire to move her hips as she feels Catra suck on her clit.

She grips the sheets beneath her, feeling the almost electric current that fills her very bones as Catra touches her. She curls the finger she has inside Adora and then she can't stop herself, her hips jogging up as they search for more. Adora can't fight the noises she's making either, soft whimpers escaping her as Catra touches her.

"That's good—I like your noises, princess." Catra sounds almost gleeful for the brief moments her mouth is unoccupied.

Adora is sure she had a response, but it disappears when Catra latches on again, her tongue providing steady pressure moving back and forth across her sodden flesh. Her legs tense and she digs her heels in the mattress, looking for something, anything to ground her.

She can feel Catra's other arm wrapped around her thigh, likely working to keep her still—she can't help her small jerky movements any more than she can help the moans that Catra pulls from her. The heat that Catra creates spreads throughout her body, starting in her loins and spreading through her limbs, and Adora fears it might burn her alive.

Except, instead of pain there's only pleasure, white hot and causing Adora to careen toward a precipice she's only ever known with Catra. It's not a particular thing that sends Adora over the edge—it's all of it. Feeling Catra's curls brush against her thighs, the wicked ways her finger and tongue moved, the added sensation of her nails digging into Adora's hip, the knowledge that Catra loves her nestled across her heart, it all drives Adora to let go and when she finds her release, her vision whites out and a hoarse shout passes her lips.

When she opens her eyes, Catra is resting against her again, this time a self-satisfied smile across her face. "You taste delightful, you know that?"

Adora lets out a cough. “I’m glad you think so.” She feels her cheeks redden which is absurd given everything they’ve done, and what Adora is contemplating now. She places a kiss on Catra’s forehead, eyeing her contentment. “Why don’t you let me taste you?”

As much as she enjoyed Catra riding her thigh, her mouth waters at the thought of touching her again.

Catra eyes her for a moment, clear interest there. “Are you sure? It’s been a trying day.” She repeats Adora’s words back to her.

Adora nods, kissing her soundly. “I’m not too tired for this. Not tonight.” There have been many days where they’ve both fallen asleep the moment they retire to bed, the same way they’ve had many sleepless nights filled with passion and caresses. But Adora doesn’t need rest now, not when she thinks of everything she still wants to give Catra. "I've told you that you've ruined me." She reminds.

Catra rolls her eyes. “If by ruined you mean turned you insatiable, perhaps.”

Adora shakes her head, reaching out to hold Catra’s hand. “There’s no one else for me, darling.” She kisses her with all of the pent-up emotion Adora had been holding back, kissing her like she’s the most precious thing Adora has. “You’ve ruined me for anyone else. Whether you wanted that annulment or not, I don’t think I’d have it in me to take another.”

“Well, good.” Catra cups Adora’s cheek, searching her gaze. “There can’t be anyone else because we belong to each other.”

Adora nods, smiling. “Of course.” Her heart squeezes in her chest, the love she feels overflowing throughout her body. “Can I have you again?”

Catra nods, laying herself out for Adora’s perusal. She can feel the trust in the act, the sure way that Catra allows her this.

Adora doesn’t tease or dally. She slips her shoulders between Catra’s thighs, her hands gently touching around where Catra wants her for a few moments. Her lips are still puffy and wet from the last time she came, but Adora makes sure to be careful when she touches her lower curls and looks for her clit.

Catra lets out a soft gasp, and Adora studies her the way she tenses and whines as she slips a finger inside of her. Adora lets out a groan at the abject lack of resistance she finds, Catra’s body welcoming her.

She leans down and takes Catra’s bud in her lips, her finger sawing in and out of her. It doesn’t take long for Catra to move against her. She’s always been freer in her movements, more confident in asking for what she wants—it’s one of the things Adora loves about her.

Adora adds another finger when she’s sure that’s what Catra needs, her whines a little too sharp to be solely of pleasure and not of need. Catra all but confirms it when she sobs in relief, her back arching off the bed and her hand coming to rest in Adora’s hair.

Adora swirls her tongue around Catra’s clit and keeps an even pace as she fucks her and she’s never felt more satisfied, not even in the middle of her own orgasm. She lifts herself up for a moment so she can watch her fingers disappear inside of her wife as she asks for more with her movements and sounds.

"You're *mine*." Adora isn’t sure where it comes from, but the words spill out of her. "*My* wife. I won't let anyone come between us."

"Yours." Catra responds breathily, her hip canting up in search of more friction.

"I love you so much." Adora can’t believe she can say it now—that she can show it in much more obvious ways than the few

indulgences she's allowed herself. "I'll spend my whole life making sure you know."

"I—ahh, me too." Catra grips her hair tighter. "I'd like it if you *focused*."

Adora bites back a laugh and pushes her tongue into Catra, fucking her with it. Catra's hand tightens in her hair, a moan escaping her. She quickly abandons that endeavor for moving up to Catra's clit, sucking on it and fingering her again, this time with more pressure. She knows the pace that tends to drive Catra over and it doesn't fail her now—five more strokes and Adora can feel Catra contract around her fingers.

This time when Catra stops whining and lays back, her eyes are glazed over much longer than the first time. Adora takes the moment to rearrange them so that she's laying across Catra's breasts, placing soft kisses on them.

She can feel Catra's breath slow, and her fingers come up into Adora's hair, softly carding through the strands.

"I promise you, Catra. I promise that whatever comes next, we'll stay together." She places a soft kiss on her chest again. She doesn't know that Catra needs the promise, but Adora knows she must make it, if only for her own peace of mind.

It's more than a few minutes before Adora hears Catra's voice again, a touch rougher from disuse.

"You know, if we were pregnant, they couldn't justify an annulment."

"That's true." Adora raises her eyebrow. "Have something to tell me?" As much as they've done the things required to conceive, Etheria has yet to bestow them with a child. It's not uncommon and Adora has been entirely unworried about it.

She laughs, shaking her head. "No, it's just an errant thought."

Still, Adora’s curiosity is piqued. "You think of children much?" She and Catra hadn’t discussed children at length, not in any concrete way in any case.

She raises an eyebrow. "Just the normal amount when you're expected to produce an heir at some point."

"I suppose that's fair." She kisses Catra's jaw. "We have time. You know as well as I do that we will be bestowed with a child when it's right."

"I know." Catra nestles closer, placing a soft kiss on Adora’s shoulder.

She sighs, feeling her eyelids grow heavier. "It might be selfish, but I'm looking forward to spending some time together—alone.” Adora whispers, her hand wrapping around Catra’s waist. “Especially now.”

“Now?”

“Now that we’re in love.” She supplies.

“We were in love before.” Catra offers stubbornly. “We just didn’t know it.”

Adora rolls her eyes. “You know that I mean.”

“I suppose I do.” Catra sighs, a shadow crossing her face. “Do you really think our parents will agree?”

Adora bites her lips, considering her. “They don’t have to. They can’t force us to get an annulment—if it’s under duress I don’t think it counts. Besides, I don’t believe they wish us unhappy.”

“That’s true.” Catra lays her head across Adora’s head. “We’ll talk to them tomorrow.”

“Of course.”

Adora runs her hands up and Catra's arm, trying to memorize this feeling—the certain that Catra is in love with her as she lies across her chest. Regardless of the opposition, Adora knows that this feeling will carry her through any strife she might encounter.

End Notes

My biggest worry now is I have two more follow ups in this universe and I doubt I'll be able to make titles that parallel the first two which is going to haunt me from now on. I love the little snap shots of this regency world and I hope you do too! Let me know your thoughts if you so wish to share :)

Kudos and comments are queen (pun intended). You can find me on Twitter, Bluesky, and Tumblr.

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